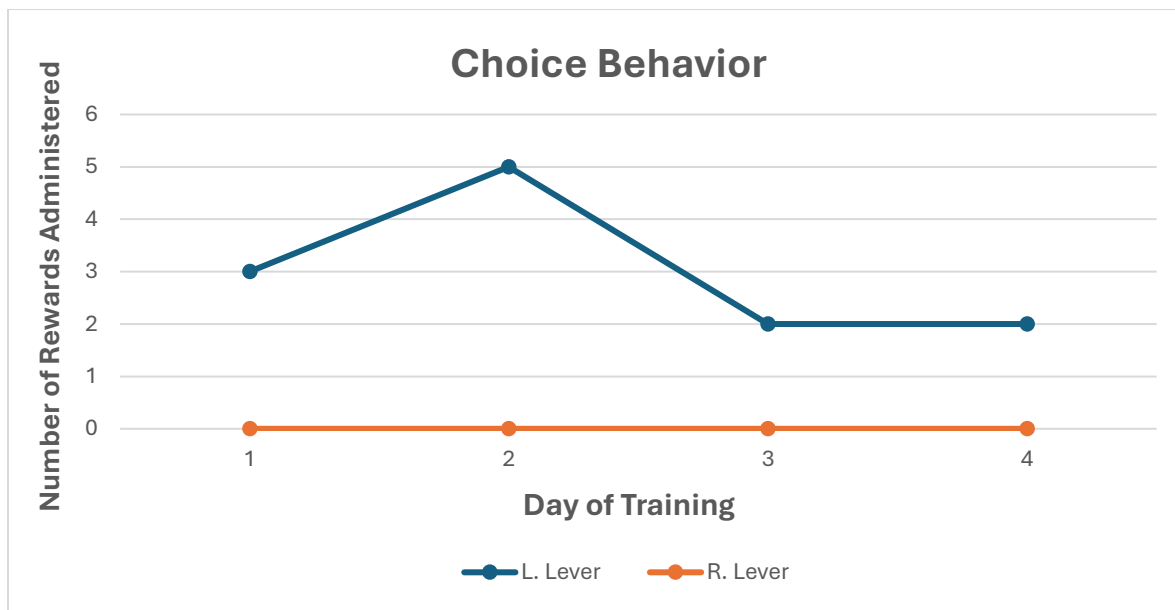


Assignment #4: Choice Behavior

Graph(s):



Short-answer questions:

Q: What is the purpose of the priming event? Was it efficacious in your experiment? What do you suppose would have happened had we not employed the choice priming event? Would your animal have performed in a manner that guaranteed maximal reward? Explain.

A: The purpose of the priming event was to help our rat generalize the behavior of "L. Lever pressing" with the newfound behavior of "R. Lever pressing." Since our rat had yet to experience the "R. Lever," it did not yet associate it with a reward and therefore was not likely to ever choose it without us employing the choice event (and we would never see a choice behavior, it would always just resort to the "L. Lever" which it knows will produce a reward). This would be the case if we did not perform a "choice priming event." Due to the nature of the reinforcement schedules (L. Lever = FI-30 (sec) & R. Lever = FR-15), the animal would certainly not have performed in a manner which guaranteed maximal reward since it would always choose the left (the opposite of Herrnstein's Matching Law). This was actually reflected in my results exactly the same, indicating the priming event was not efficacious in my experiment.

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11/14/2025

Q: Describe your data in this experiment. Describe how your observations throughout this experiment compared to your predictions. Were you right in your hypothetical estimations? If you had the opportunity, what might you have done differently to best guarantee maximal reinforcement? Explain.

A: My data for this experiment shows that the “priming event” was completely ineffective and, consequentially, my rat was never rewarded once for “R. Lever” presses (as if didn’t notice that was a choice, and as if we had never carried out the “priming event”). This was surprising to me, and my experimental results did not match the expectations/predictions that I had. I expected more “R. Lever” presses since Fixed-Ratio schedules tend to provide higher response rates than Fixed-Interval schedules. Next time, if I were to repeat the experiment again, I would modify the reinforcement schedule for the “R. Lever” during the “priming event” to be CRF (FR-1 instead of FR-2) which would hopefully encourage an increased interaction with it during the “priming event” (as well as with the choice-behavior period).